

03/09/2025

Contempt, Scheming up, Given that, Kaput, In Vague

1. Contempt (तिरस्कार) (Noun) (kən-'tempt) (Tone: Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** The feeling that someone or something is beneath consideration, worthless, or deserving scorn.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** गहरी घृणा या तिरस्कार।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *contemptus* → Old French *contempre* → Middle English *contempt* → Modern English "Contempt"
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** Disdain, Scorn, Derision
 - **Antonyms:** Respect, Admiration, Esteem
- **Connotation:** Strongly negative; indicates arrogance or dismissal.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A teacher looking at a student who cheated in the exam with disgust.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In corporate leadership, contempt often arises when employees feel undervalued or when leaders look down upon suggestions from their subordinates. Such a mindset creates friction and lowers morale. In contrast, leaders who treat employees with respect foster collaboration and innovation. For instance, when a manager expresses contempt for feedback, the organizational culture deteriorates, as individuals avoid contributing. Thus, contempt acts as a silent disruptor of productivity.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

-  **Correct:** *He spoke with contempt about corruption in politics.* (उसने राजनीति में भ्रष्टाचार के बारे में तिरस्कार से बात की।)
-  **Incorrect:** *He showed contempt to his homework.* (Homework पर contempt नहीं दिखाया जा सकता; सही होगा disrespect या ignorance.)

- **Word Hack of the Day (in 50 words):**

- Use contempt as a mental safeguard. Whenever you sense superiority creeping in, pause: is this true contempt or just ego? Channel contempt not toward people but toward destructive habits, like laziness or dishonesty. Redirecting scorn inward helps dismantle personal weaknesses instead of alienating others unfairly.

- **Example (English + Hindi Equivalent) + Grammar Breakdown:**

- *She looked at him with utter contempt.* (उसने उसे घोर तिरस्कार से देखा।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Transitive + Prepositional): looked at
 - O (Object): him
 - + (Adverbial Phrase of Manner): with utter contempt
 - ↳ N (Noun inside Prepositional Phrase): contempt
 - ↳ M (Modifier/Adjective): utter

- **Common Collocations:**

- utter contempt, hold in contempt, contempt of court, with contempt.

- **My Statement:**

- Your case may be dismissed for contempt of court.
- He treated his assigned teammates with contempt.
- He looked at the guy sitting next to him with utter contempt.

2. Scheming up (षड्यंत्र रचना करना) (Phrasal Verb) ('ski:-mɪŋ ʌp) (Tone: Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** To plot or plan something secretly, usually with a manipulative or cunning intention.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** गुप्त रूप से योजना बनाना (अक्सर नकारात्मक उद्देश्य से)।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Proto-Germanic *skemō* ("plan") → **Old French** *eschemer* → English "scheme" → "scheming up" (phrasal usage).
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** Conspiring, Plotting, Contriving
 - **Antonyms:** Openly planning, Transparent action
- **Connotation:** Negative; suggests manipulation, cunning, trickery.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Two employees whispering about undermining their boss.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In political history, leaders have often been accused of scheming up plans behind closed doors. These strategies might range from secretly forming alliances to sabotaging opponents. In modern corporate settings, office politics often reflects the same:

employees scheming up ways to gain promotions at the expense of others. While planning is natural, the secrecy and selfish intent make “scheming up” pejorative.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** *They were scheming up a plan to oust the chairman.* (वे अध्यक्ष को हटाने की योजना रच रहे थे।)
-  **Incorrect:** *He is scheming up for dinner tonight.* (Neutral planning ≠ scheming up.)

- **Word Hack of the Day:**

- Scheming up is a mental signal for proactive creativity, though it carries a sly edge. Use it to remind yourself that not every plan must be grand or rigid—sometimes, clever improvisation drives results. The trick is to keep schemes ethical, ensuring your strategies lean toward innovation rather than manipulation.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- *The rivals were scheming up a trap.* (प्रतिद्वंद्वी एक जाल बुन रहे थे।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): The rivals
 - V (Verb – Phrasal, Transitive): were scheming up
 - O (Object): a trap
 - ↳ N (Noun inside Object): trap
 - ↳ M (Modifier/Determiner): a

- **Common Collocations:**

- scheming up plans, scheming up plots, scheming up strategies.

- **My Statement:**

- The opponents were scheming up plans to defeat them in the upcoming elections.
- The workers were scheming up ways to unfairly demand higher salaries.
- The hero was scheming up plots to defeat the villain throughout the movie.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

3. Given that (चूँकि/यदि यह मान लिया जाए कि) (Conjunction/Phrase) ('giv.ən ðæt) (Tone: Neutral)

- **Meaning (English):** Considering the fact that; in view of the fact.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** यह मानकर कि; चूँकि।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *donare* (“to give”) → **Old English *giefan*** → Middle English *given* → **Usage in conditional connector “given that.”**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** Considering, Seeing that, In view of
 - **Antonyms:** Regardless of, Despite
- **Connotation:** Neutral/logical; often academic or analytical.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A professor stating: “*Given that demand is rising, prices will also rise.*”



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Economists often predict future outcomes by applying “given that” statements. For instance, given that consumer demand has increased steadily over the past quarter, companies may raise prices to balance supply and demand. In law, “given that” functions

as a premise-builder, strengthening logical arguments. It is crucial for hypothesis framing in academic writing as well.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** *Given that she had all the qualifications, she was hired immediately.* (चूँकि उसके पास सभी योग्यताएँ थीं, उसे तुरंत नियुक्त कर लिया गया।)
-  **Incorrect:** *I given that her a gift.* (Grammatically wrong; mixing tenses.)

- **Word Hack of the Day:**

- Use given that as a mental cue for logical clarity. It reminds you to ground decisions in existing conditions rather than imagined ones. Instead of debating “what ifs,” acknowledge present realities and adapt. This phrase trains your thinking to be conditional yet practical, sharpening reasoning and decision-making skills.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- *Given that it is raining, the match will be postponed.* (चूँकि बारिश हो रही है, मैच स्थगित होगा।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - Adv. Clause of Condition (Subordinator: “Given that”):
 - S (Subject): it
 - V (Verb – Linking): is
 - SC (Subject Complement – Present Participle Phrase): raining
 -
 - Main Clause:
 - S (Subject): the match
 - V (Verb – Modal + Passive): will be postponed

- **Common Collocations:**

- given that fact, given that condition, given that situation.

- **My Statement:**

- Given that he bought a phone, he will likely buy a charger as well.
- Given that the government has announced a complete lockdown, no vehicles will be running on the roads.
- Given that he stood first in his class, he must have studied hard.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

4. Kaput (नष्ट/समाप्त) (Adjective) (kə-'pu:t) (Tone: Informal, Humorous)

- **Meaning (English):** Broken, useless, finished, or destroyed.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** नष्ट, खराब, बेकार।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - German *kaputt* (“broken”) → **borrowed into English in the early 20th century.**
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** Broken, Ruined, Shattered
 - **Antonyms:** Functioning, Working, Active
- **Connotation:** Informal; often humorous or casual.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A person holding a dead phone battery saying, “It’s kaput!”



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

In technology, systems can go kaput without warning. Servers crash, hard drives fail, or networks suddenly stop working. For engineers, describing a system as “kaput” highlights its total failure in an informal but clear manner. Unlike “damaged,” kaput implies irreparable or complete breakdown. For example, when a car engine goes kaput in the middle of the road, it’s not just malfunctioning—it’s done for.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** *My old radio is kaput after the storm.* (तूफ़ान के बाद मेरा पुराना रेडियो खराब हो गया।)
-  **Incorrect:** *The kaput concert was fun.* (Concert cannot be kaput if it was fun.)

- **Word Hack of the Day:**

- When something is kaput—a gadget, habit, or even a plan—don't waste energy trying to revive it beyond reason. Recognize finality as freedom to pivot. Accepting what's broken allows you to redirect resources toward what actually works. Letting go of the kaput clears paths for innovation and growth.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- *The machine went kaput last night.* (कल रात मशीन खराब हो गई।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): The machine
 - V (Verb – Intransitive): went
 - SC (Subject Complement – Predicative Adjective): kaput
 - + (Adverbial of Time): last night

- **Common Collocations:**

- went kaput, totally kaput, machinery kaput.

- **My Statement:**

- The plans and routine went kaput after working smoothly for three hours.
- The kaput mobile is left in the drawer. You can now do whatever you want with it.
- The machine went kaput after operating for 1,000 hours.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]

5. In Vague (अस्पष्ट/असंगत रूप से) (Phrase/Adverbial Use) (in veig) (Tone: Neutral → Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** In an unclear, indefinite, or imprecise manner.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** अस्पष्ट तरीके से।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *vagus* ("wandering, uncertain") → **French *vague*** → English "vague" → phrase "in vague."
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** Indistinct, Ambiguous, Unclear
 - **Antonyms:** Precise, Definite, Clear
- **Connotation:** Often negative; suggests lack of clarity or direction.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A student giving an answer "in vague" during viva exam.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (in 100 words):**

Scientific research discourages explanations given "in vague." Precision and accuracy are fundamental to scientific inquiry. If hypotheses or conclusions are written in vague terms, the credibility of research diminishes. In communication, being "in vague" can create confusion, misinterpretations, and even distrust. Thus, avoiding vagueness is central to professional and academic clarity.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

-  **Correct:** *His answer was in vague, leaving the professor dissatisfied.* (उसका उत्तर अस्पष्ट था, जिससे प्रोफेसर असंतुष्ट हो गए।)
-  **Incorrect:** *She wrote the essay in vague handwriting.* (Handwriting ≠ vague; should use “illegible.”)

- **Word Hack of the Day:**

- Avoid living or expressing yourself in vague terms—whether in speech, writing, or decision-making. Vagueness creates confusion, weakens trust, and delays progress. Be precise with your words, clear in your goals, and specific in your plans. Clarity attracts solutions; vagueness multiplies problems. Choose exactness—it’s empowering.

- **Example + Grammar:**

- *The instructions were given in vague.* (निर्देश अस्पष्ट रूप से दिए गए।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): The instructions
 - V (Verb – Passive): were given
 - + (Adverbial of Manner – Prepositional Phrase): in vague terms

- **Common Collocations:**

- in vague terms, reply in vague, explanation in vague.

- **My Statement:**

- He explained the topic in vague terms based on his own understanding.
- Her reply, in vague terms, never made sense.
- The objective was vague, making it difficult for the reader.

- **My Notes:** [Placeholder]